

Here is a **practical list of essential keyboard shortcut keys**, especially useful for students and programmers.

1. Basic Editing

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + C	Copy
Ctrl + X	Cut
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + Y	Redo
Ctrl + A	Select All
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save As
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + F	Find/Search
Ctrl + H	Find and Replace

2. Text Navigation & Selection

Shortcut	Action
Home	Beginning of line
End	End of line
Ctrl + Home	Beginning of document
Ctrl + End	End of document
Ctrl + Left/Right	Move one word
Shift + Arrow	Select text
Ctrl + Shift + Left/Right	Select one word

Shortcut	Action
Shift + Home/End	Select to start/end of line
Ctrl + Backspace	Delete previous word
Ctrl + Delete	Delete next word

3. Windows Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Alt + Tab	Switch between apps
Alt + F4	Close current app
Win + D	Show desktop
Win + E	Open File Explorer
Win + L	Lock PC
Win + R	Open Run
Win + I	Open Settings
Win + S	Search
Win + Tab	Task View
Win + V	Clipboard History
Win + Shift + S	Screenshot selection
PrtSc	Screenshot
Win + .	Emoji/Symbol panel
Win + Ctrl + D	New virtual desktop
Win + Ctrl + Left/Right	Switch virtual desktops

4. Browser Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + T	New tab
Ctrl + W	Close tab
Ctrl + Shift + T	Reopen closed tab
Ctrl + Tab	Next tab
Ctrl + Shift + Tab	Previous tab
Ctrl + L	Address bar
Ctrl + R / F5	Refresh
Ctrl + Shift + R	Hard refresh
Ctrl + D	Bookmark page
Ctrl + +	Zoom in
Ctrl + -	Zoom out
Ctrl + 0	Reset zoom
F11	Fullscreen

5. File Explorer

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + N	New folder
F2	Rename
Delete	Move to Recycle Bin
Shift + Delete	Permanently delete
Alt + Enter	Properties
Ctrl + L	Address bar
Alt + Left/Right	Back/Forward

6. Programming / VS Code

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + P	Command Palette
Ctrl + P	Quick Open File
Ctrl + Shift + F	Search in all files
Ctrl + /	Toggle comment
Alt + Up/Down	Move line
Shift + Alt + Up/Down	Duplicate line
Ctrl + D	Select next matching word
Ctrl + Shift + K	Delete line
Ctrl + Enter	New line below
Ctrl + Shift + Enter	New line above
Ctrl + Space	Suggestions/IntelliSense
F2	Rename symbol
F12	Go to definition
Alt + Left	Go back
Alt + Right	Go forward
Ctrl + ``	Open terminal
Ctrl + B	Toggle sidebar
Ctrl + Shift + E	Explorer
Ctrl + Shift + G	Source Control
Ctrl + Shift + X	Extensions

7. Power User Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Shift + Esc	Task Manager
Win + X	Power User menu
Win + Arrow Keys	Snap windows
Win + M	Minimize all windows
Win + Shift + M	Restore minimized windows
Win + Number	Open pinned taskbar app
Alt + Space	Window menu

Most important 15 to memorize first

Ctrl + C, Ctrl + V, Ctrl + Z, Ctrl + S, Ctrl + A, Alt + Tab, Win + E, Win + D, Win + Shift + S, Ctrl + Shift + T, Ctrl + T, Ctrl + W, Win + V, Ctrl + Shift + Esc, Win + I.

For you as a **CSE student**, I recommend learning these shortcuts first because they will speed up your programming and computer work significantly.